Quantifiers

Objective: Use quantifiers (*some, any, much, many, a lot of, few, a few, little, a little*) correctly with countable and uncountable nouns.

In two lines: Quantifiers tell us how much or how many. The right choice depends on whether the noun is countable or uncountable and whether the sentence is positive, negative or a question.

Countable	Uncountable	Both
many	much	some / any
a few / few	a little / little	a lot of / lots of
several	a great deal of	no / enough
many customers	much money	a lot of products

Figure 1: Quantifiers classified by the type of noun they go with.

🔵 Rules and concepts

1. **Countable nouns** have a plural (*jobs, banks*); **uncountable nouns** do not (*money, information, advice*).
2. **some** in positive sentences and offers; **any** in negatives and questions: *We don't have any stock.*
3. **many** + plural countable; **much** + uncountable, mostly in negatives and questions.
4. **a lot of / lots of** go with both types, mainly in positive sentences.
5. **a few / a little** = a small but sufficient amount (positive idea).
6. **few / little** = almost none (negative idea): *Few people bought the product.*

🟢 Examples

1. Choose: The company doesn't have (much / many) money. **Answer:** much.
   Explanation: *money* is uncountable.

2. Choose: Luckily, I have (a few / few) good ideas, so I can start a small business. **Answer:** a few. **Explanation:** positive meaning, enough to start.
3. Correct: Can you give me an advice? **Answer:** Can you give me some advice? (or a piece of advice)

🟠 Common BAC mistakes

- Pluralising uncountable nouns: *informations, advices, equipments*.
- Using *much* with countable nouns: *much customers*.
- Confusing *few* (negative) and *a few* (positive).
- Using *some* in negative sentences: *I don't have some time*.

🟡 Quick review

- many / a few / few + countable.
- much / a little / little + uncountable.
- some (positive), any (negative, question).
- a lot of + both types.
- a few / a little = enough; few / little = not enough.

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